GROW IN CHRIST | IN-DEPTH STUDY 1

Living by Faith

Trusting God Beyond What We See

Primary Scripture: 2 Corinthians 5:7 • Memory Verse: 2 Corinthians 5:7

Supporting Scriptures: Hebrews 11:1–6; Romans 10:17; Proverbs 3:5–6; Mark 9:23–24

Central Teaching Truth

Biblical faith is trusting God because of who He is and what He has revealed in Scripture, even when circumstances are uncertain and feelings change.

Lesson Objective

Understand biblical faith, distinguish faith from feelings, and practice trusting God's Word through everyday obedience.

Introduction — When the Outcome Is Unclear

A believer may pray about a family problem, a financial concern, or a difficult decision without seeing an immediate answer. Uncertainty can bring the question, "Does God hear me?" Biblical faith is not confidence that every outcome will match our wishes. It is confidence in God's character and wisdom, even while we wait.

1. Observation — What Does Scripture Say?

Read Hebrews 11:1–6 and 2 Corinthians 5:7. Answer from the passages before discussing their application.

1. How does Hebrews 11:1 describe faith?

2. What does Hebrews 11:6 say about coming to God?

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Observation — Continued

3. What examples of faith do you see in Hebrews 11:4–5?

4. What contrast does Paul make in 2 Corinthians 5:7?

2. Interpretation — What Does Scripture Mean?

Faith has an object: the living God revealed in Jesus Christ. It is not merely optimism or confidence in our own ability. Romans 10:17 connects faith with hearing the message concerning Christ. Biblical trust grows as we attend to what God has spoken.

Hebrews 11 describes people who obeyed God without knowing every detail of what would happen. Faith does not eliminate questions or grief. It leads us to trust God's character and follow His Word while circumstances remain uncertain.

Feelings are real, but they are changeable. Feelings cannot serve as our final authority. Scripture teaches us to weigh our responses against God's truth rather than treat emotional certainty as proof of His favor.

Teaching Diagram — The Foundation of Faith

GOD'S WORD
What God reveals about Himself and His promises

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TRUSTING FAITH
Believing His truth and relying on His character

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DAILY OBEDIENCE
Following Christ even when feelings and outcomes change

Key truth: God's Word is the foundation; faith is our response; obedience is one visible expression of that trust.

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3. Application — How Do We Live God's Word?

1. What situation is currently testing my trust in God?

2. Am I relying more on my feelings or assumptions than on what Scripture teaches?

3. What specific truth about God speaks to my situation?

4. What is one wise, biblical step of obedience I can take without knowing the outcome?

Reflection: Faith Is Not Denial

Trusting God does not mean pretending that pain, fear, or unanswered questions do not exist. In Mark 9:24 a father brought both belief and weakness to Jesus. Honest prayer and faithful obedience can coexist with uncertainty.

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4. Seven-Day Faith Practice

Read Proverbs 3:5–6 each morning. Write one concern and one appropriate step of obedience. Review how the passage challenges you to acknowledge God in that situation.

Day	My concern or question	My step of trust and obedience
1		
2		
3		
4		
5		
6		
7		

5. Group Discussion

How can we encourage someone whose prayers seem unanswered without suggesting that the person simply lacks enough faith?

Notes from our discussion:

6. Memory Verse

2 Corinthians 5:7 — Read the verse in your Bible, explain it in your own words, and practice memorizing it.

Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father, teach us to trust You because You are faithful. Strengthen our faith through Your Word, especially when life is uncertain. Help us respond with wisdom and obedience, and rest in Your care. In Jesus' name, Amen.